

REBOOT OF SCI-FI FILMS

Wouldn't we all like to see a remake or a spin-off of our favourite Sci-Fi films? Well acclaimed director Ridley Scott is planning a reboot of his popular science fiction film Blade Runner. Here's Wired's list of six such films we'd love to see on the big screen again. Read more <http://bit.ly/pHRewQ>

COMPUTABLE KNOWLEDGE INFOGRAPH

Humanity has come a long way since 20,000 BC. Here's an infographic mapping key achievements in systematic data and computable knowledge. Check it out here <http://bit.ly/mUbB6J>

IS YOUR BROWSER SAFE?

In a test conducted by NSS Labs, IE 9 has topped the charts in fighting against malware with a 99 per cent detection rate. Sounds like guys at NSS might be Windows fanboys. Anyhow, here's CNET's analysis of the test where they take all other browsers and see what the scores actually mean. Read more <http://cnet.co/nOVOav>

SO WHO'S NEXT AFTER HP'S webOS?

This year kicked off with six major platforms in the mobile arena. Now there are only four. With the fall of webOS who's next in line to kick the bucket? Is it RIM's turn? Only time will tell, meanwhile read this prediction and see if you concur. <http://bit.ly/qzWAGQ>

SHORTS

What Makes Content Go Viral? Awe, Angst, and A-Holes

- By MarkHachman

It's quite surprising what makes some blogs, posts or campaigns go viral. Read on to find out...



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What makes a tweet, blog post, or ad campaign go viral? According to one of two recent studies, one of the best ways is to inspire awe in the reader. And if that fails, well, tick them off.

Last week, Chris Menning discovered that empathy leads to content "going viral," or being repeatedly passed around the Web, both on social networks and elsewhere. Surprised?

A forthcoming study by two assistant professors at the Wharton School at the University of Pennsylvania, meanwhile, parsed 7,000 articles in The New York

Times to try and understand what boosted an article onto the "most emailed" list. The short answer? Provoking an emotional reaction via the three A's: anger, anxiety, and awe.

In a sense, both studies reiterate the conventional wisdom: "if it bleeds, it leads" is a journalistic cliché, and so-called "yellow journalism" has sold papers for a number of decades. Instead of provoking outrage or disgust, however, Menning took a slightly different tack: he discovered that a reader's sympathy for social awkwardness could create an empathic connection that prompted users to share that content online.

And Menning tested his hypothesis, creating a new meme ("10 Charts of Awkward Situations," or "lolgraphs") that drove three times as much traffic by referral as those that clicked directly on the BuzzFeed site.

Interestingly, Menning also found that a second meme, pairing a stock photo with a first-world cliché ("I poured my cereal into the bowl without checking to see if we still had milk. We didn't," one reads, against a photo that suggests abject despair) failed to take off, until someone

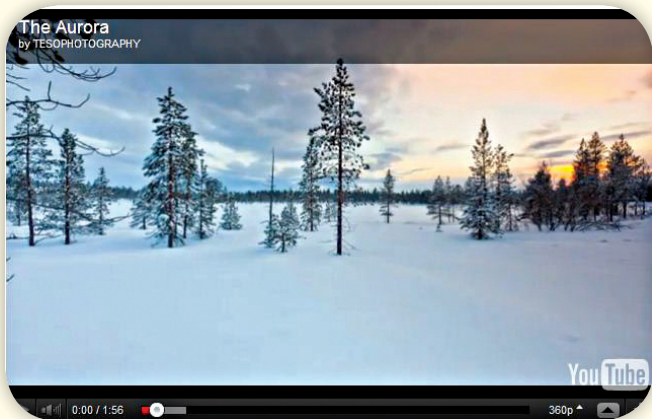
removed the BuzzFeed tagline and republished it on Tumblr. There, it attracted over 68,000 Tumblr interactions and started spreading via variations on the theme.

"In attempting to create content that will go viral, many try hard to incorporate popular Internet memes hoping that the right catch phrase, reference, or format will be the magic bullet," Menning wrote. "Most often, it's not about the form that the meme takes, but the relatable common experiences that it conveys."

TICK PEOPLE OFF, AND THEY'LL SHARE - IT'S TRUE

Jonah Berger, who has studied the problem at the University of Pennsylvania, came up with a different conclusion: emotional arousal. Berger has published his second paper on the subject, which is due to be published in the The Journal of Marketing Research at a forthcoming date.

In January, Berger's paper in Psychological Science concluded that arousal drives sharing, specifically high-arousal emotions like anxiety or amusement, versus low-arousal emotions like sadness or contentment. Berger's January study showed users an emotionally-charged video, than and neutral video and article. A second experiment forced users to jog (physical, though not sexual, arousal). In both experiments, users who were emotionally aroused or physically aroused shared content more than those who weren't.



An awe inspiring video hand picked by Mashable.com